STRUCTURE OF THE EARTH

Look at the following table showing information about the internal structure of the Earth and answer the questions below.

Layer	Depth (km)	Thickness (km)	State of Matter	Temperature (°C)	% Earth's mass	% Earth's volume
Crust	0 – 35	35	Solid	0 – 870	0.5	1
Mantle	35 – 2890	2855	Solid/Plastic	870 – 3700	67	84
Outer Core	2890 – 5100	2210	Liquid	3700 – 4300	30.8	10
Inner Core	5100 – 6378	1278	Solid	4300 – 7200	1.7	5

Questions

1. List the layers of the Earth in order from the centre to the outside.
2. Which layers inside the Earth are in the solid state?
3. Which layer holds the largest proportion of the mass of the Earth?
4. Select and draw the most appropriate type of graph to show the thickness of each major layer of the Earth.
5. Select and draw the most appropriate type of graph to show the % of the Earth's mass in each layer.
6. Draw a divided bar graph showing the % of the Earth's volume in each layer.
7. Research the 'Lithosphere' and compare it to the crust and the mantle.

Extension

Use appropriate graphs to show whether there is a relationship between the following:

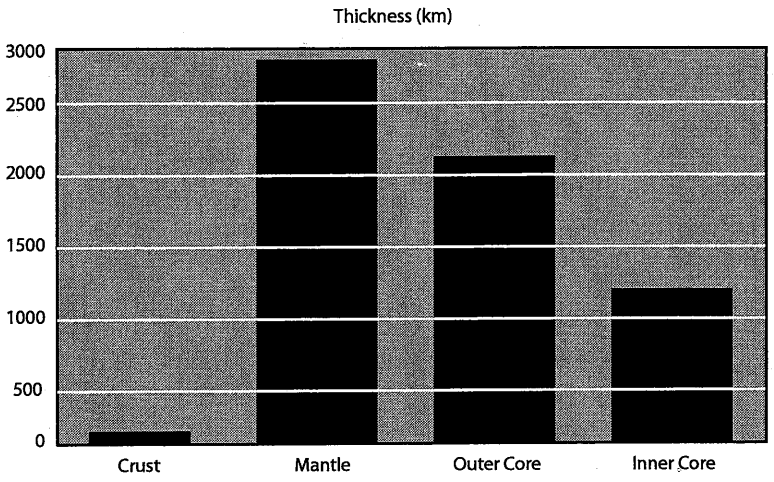
a) depth and temperature

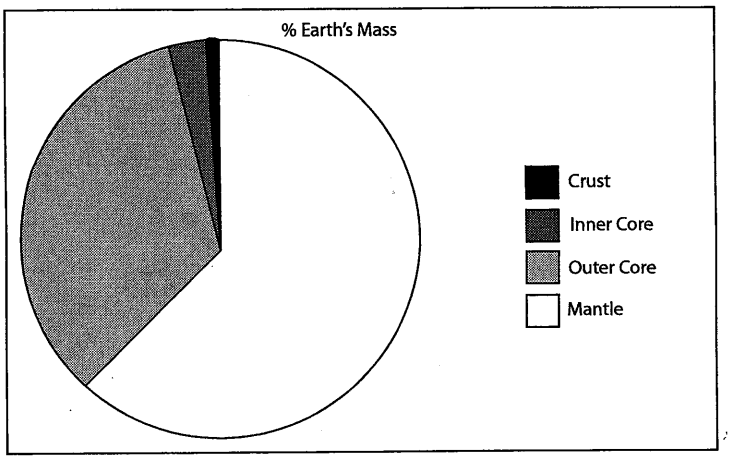
b) temperature and % of the Earth's mass

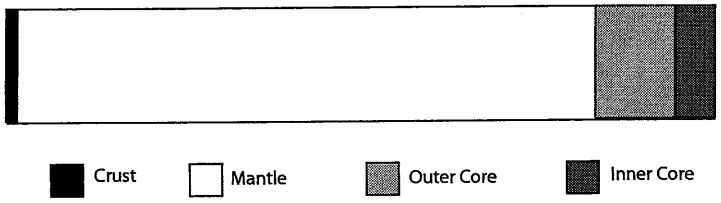
c) depth and % of the Earth's volume

STRUCTURE OF THE EARTH

ANSWERS

1. Inner core, outer core, mantle, crust.
2. Crust and inner core. The mantle is said to behave like plastic or plasticine. It is under enormous pressure and high temperatures and it does 'flow'.
3. The mantle.
4. 

5. 

6. 

7. The lithosphere is made up of the crust and the upper part of the mantle.